

Environmental Assessment Practitioners Association of South Africa

*Advancing environmental assessment
practice in South Africa*



ESTABLISHING EAPASA CORE COMPETENCIES FOR REGISTRATOIN OF AN ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL DESIGNATION:

**Social Impact Assessment Practitioner
(SIAP)**

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1. Introduction

This document consolidates the full professional framework for the Social Impact Assessment Practitioner (SIAP) designation, established under the Environmental Assessment Practitioners Association of South Africa (EAPASA) as part of an application to the South African Qualifications Authority (SAQA) for the registration of an additional professional designation.

Social Impact Assessment (SIA) is a critical component of responsible development in South Africa and globally. It ensures that the social consequences of proposed projects, programmes, and policies are properly evaluated, managed, and monitored. The SIAP designation formalises the standards expected of practitioners in this field, providing clarity for employers, regulators, affected communities, and practitioners themselves.

Purpose of This Document

This integrated framework document has been compiled to serve as the definitive reference for all aspects of the SIAP and Candidate SIAP professional designation. It brings together five source documents into one cohesive reference:

Section	Topic	Description
1	Working Definitions	Definitions of SIA and Stakeholder Engagement Practitioners
2	Professional Core Competencies	Seven competency domains for fully registered SIAPs
3	Candidate Core Competencies	Scenario-based competency indicators for Candidate SIAPs
4	Continuing Professional Development (CPD)	CPD policy, categories, points, and record-keeping
5	Roles & Qualifications	Role descriptions, educational requirements, and RPL pathways

How to Use This Document

This document is intended for use by:

- Aspiring and registered SIA practitioners seeking clarity on competency expectations, CPD obligations, and qualification requirements.
- Employers and project proponents who need to understand the qualifications and responsibilities of SIA professionals on their teams.
- Regulatory and accreditation bodies reviewing the SIAP designation standards.
- Academic institutions developing or aligning programmes with SIAP competency requirements.

- Mentors and supervisors of Candidate SIAPs guiding development toward full registration.

About EAPASA

The Environmental Assessment Practitioners Association of South Africa (EAPASA) is the professional body responsible for the accreditation and regulation of environmental assessment practitioners in South Africa. EAPASA is registered with SAQA and operates under the requirements of the National Qualifications Framework Act. The SIAP Board operates under EAPASA's mandate to establish and uphold standards specific to Social Impact Assessment practice.

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Section 1: Working Definition

The following working definition has been developed to support the SAQA application for registration of the SIAP additional professional designation.

Social Impact Assessment (SIA) Practitioner

A Social Impact Assessment (SIA) practitioner is a professional who evaluates the social effects of proposed projects, policies, or programmes on communities and individuals. Their role is to analyse the potential positive and negative impacts on people's quality of life, culture, livelihoods, and social relationships.

SIA practitioners are social scientists with strong social research skills. They are able to integrate multiple perspectives and data sources in SIA reports. They have good analytical, interpersonal, and engagement skills. Their assessments help ensure that projects are socially sustainable and ethically sound.

Key Responsibilities of an SIA Practitioner

- Identifying stakeholders: Determining who the key individuals, groups, or organisations are that will be affected by or have an interest in a project or decision.
- Developing engagement strategies: Designing plans for interacting with stakeholders, which may involve consultations, public meetings, surveys, or focus groups.
- Stakeholder engagement: Engaging with communities, government agencies, and other stakeholders to understand concerns and expectations.
- Conducting assessments: Evaluating how a development project (like a new road, dam, or factory) might affect local populations.
- Recommending measures: Proposing ways to minimise negative social impacts and enhance benefits for affected groups.
- Monitoring and follow-up: Ensuring that mitigation measures are implemented and evaluating their effectiveness over time.

Section 2: Professional Core Competencies

This section sets out the seven core competency domains required for registration as a fully qualified Social Impact Assessment Practitioner (SIAP). Each competency is defined and described in terms of the core knowledge required, the practical skills expected, measurable performance indicators, and examples of proficiency at different levels of expertise.

These competencies form the foundation of the SIAP assessment and are used to evaluate applications for registration, recognition of prior learning, and renewal of professional status.

Core Competency 1: Social Impact Assessment Design & Methodology

Definition	Design robust SIA studies using appropriate qualitative and quantitative methods and mixed-methods approaches.
Core Knowledge	SIA principles; study design; sampling; comparative methods; methodological approaches (e.g., quantitative surveys, qualitative interviews, participatory action research, mixed-methods designs); validity, reliability; ethics and consent; knowledge of relevant ethical guidelines and standards.
Skills	Develop terms of reference; select methods; design surveys and qualitative guides; sampling strategies; integrate mixed methods; data analysis and interpretation; report writing.
Indicators	Produces clear, methodologically justified study designs; selects appropriate tools; documents methodological limitations transparently.
Proficiency Examples	Foundational — able to follow existing SIA protocols. Expert — able to designs multi-site, mixed-methods SIA with clear justification.

Core Competency 2: Stakeholder Identification & Engagement

Definition	Identify, map, and engage affected and interested stakeholders throughout the assessment lifecycle.
Core Knowledge	Stakeholder mapping techniques; power and interest analysis; informed consent; community dynamics; knowledge of conflict resolution, negotiation, and culturally appropriate communication strategies.
Skills	Facilitate consultations; build trust; adapt engagement strategies for different groups; ensure inclusive participation; conflict mediation; building consensus; and managing expectations.
Indicators	Stakeholder maps produced; diverse groups included; engagement records show meaningful participation.
Proficiency Examples	Intermediate — able to lead inclusive community consultations. Expert — able to design stakeholder engagement strategies for high-conflict contexts.

Core Competency 3: Participatory Methods and Community-Based Approaches

Definition	Use participatory tools to ensure community voice and local knowledge shape assessment findings and mitigation.
Core Knowledge	Knowledge of different participatory techniques (e.g., focus group facilitation, participatory mapping, community surveys, community mapping, participatory monitoring and evaluation (PM&E)).
Skills	Adapting participatory methods to different cultural contexts and literacy levels, and ensuring inclusivity of marginalised groups.
Indicators	Community-led data produced; feedback loops established; local priorities reflected in recommendations.
Proficiency Examples	Expert — ability to co-create research instruments and PM&E frameworks with communities.

Core Competency 4: Social and Cultural Context Analysis

Definition	Analyse local social structures, cultural norms, livelihoods, gender relations, and power dynamics that influence impacts.
Core Knowledge	Anthropology/sociology/social science basics; gender and social inclusion frameworks; socio-economic profiling.
Skills	Conduct context scans, household surveys, key-informant interviews; synthesize cultural drivers of vulnerability and resilience.
Indicators	Contextual analyses that explain differential impacts; tailored mitigation measures for vulnerable groups.
Proficiency Examples	Expert — able to identify structural drivers of social risk and impacts, and recommend culturally appropriate interventions.

Core Competency 5: Impact Assessment and Mitigation Planning

Definition	Develop and implement practical and effective mitigation and management plans to minimise negative social impacts and maximise positive ones.
Core Knowledge	Hierarchy of mitigation; mitigation strategies (e.g., avoidance, minimisation, compensation); monitoring and evaluation techniques; and relevant regulatory requirements.
Skills	Develop mitigation plans; design monitoring programmes; evaluate the effectiveness of mitigation measures.
Indicators	Mitigation plans are practical, feasible, and aligned with best practices; monitoring programmes are in place to track the effectiveness of mitigation measures.
Proficiency Examples	Foundational — can contribute to a mitigation plan under supervision. Expert — independently develops and implements comprehensive mitigation and management plans for complex projects.

Core Competency 6: Legal and Regulatory Framework

Definition	Demonstrate knowledge of relevant legal and regulatory requirements for SIAs, including national laws, international standards, and industry best practices.
Core Knowledge	Relevant laws and regulations; environmental impact assessment processes; and permitting requirements.
Skills	Interpret and apply legal and regulatory requirements to SIA practice.
Indicators	SIAs are conducted in compliance with all applicable legal and regulatory requirements.
Proficiency Examples	Foundational — able to understand basic legal and regulatory requirements for SIAs. Expert — can provide expert advice on legal and regulatory issues related to SIAs.

Core Competency 7: Communication and Reporting

Definition	Effectively communicate SIA findings to stakeholders through clear, concise, and culturally appropriate reports and presentations.
Core Knowledge	Principles of effective communication; report writing; and presentation skills.
Skills	Prepare written reports; deliver presentations; communicate complex information to diverse audiences.
Indicators	SIA reports are clear, concise, and accessible to stakeholders.
Proficiency Examples	Foundational — can prepare basic SIA reports under supervision. Expert — develops and delivers compelling presentations to diverse audiences.

Section 3: Candidate Core Competencies

This section presents the core competency framework for Candidate Social Impact Assessment Practitioners (Candidate SIAPs). The competencies are structured around a scenario-based assessment approach, where candidates are evaluated on their ability to apply theoretical knowledge to a realistic project context.

Assessment Scenario

The following scenario is used as the reference context for all candidate competency questions:

Project Scenario: SunRise Energy Solar PV Facility

Project Proponent: SunRise Energy (Pty) Ltd — an independent renewable energy company operating in South Africa.

Project Description: A 200MW solar photovoltaic (PV) facility with associated 132kV transmission line and access roads on approximately 400 hectares in Makhanda Local Municipality, Sarah Baartman District, Eastern Cape Province.

Community Context: KwaDlamini Village (~2,000 residents, primarily isiXhosa-speaking). Key livelihoods include small-scale farming, social grants, and informal trading. Active traditional leadership structures and an elected ward councillor.

Timeline: Feasibility 6 months | Construction 18–24 months (~300 workers at peak) | Operations 25 years | Decommissioning ~1 year.

Regulatory Context: Full EIA process under NEMA EIA Regulations. GreenPath Environmental Consultants (Pty) Ltd appointed to conduct the EIA.

Candidate Competency 1: Understanding SIA Principles and Frameworks

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: SIA Purpose	The project proponent asks why an SIA is necessary when environmental studies are already underway. Explain the purpose of an SIA for this project and how it helps guide project decisions. (150 words)	Explains distinct role of SIA (focus on people, not only environment). Links SIA to informed decision-making and planning. Mentions key social aspects (livelihoods, services, wellbeing, culture etc.).
Question 2: Timing and Principles	Describe when in the project lifecycle an SIA is most valuable and name key principles or frameworks that should guide it. (150 words)	Identifies project phases (planning, construction, operation, decommissioning). Explains why early assessment is critical. Mentions core principles (participation, inclusivity, transparency, mitigation hierarchy). References frameworks (NEMA, IFC, IAIA or equivalent).

Candidate Competency 2: Understanding SIA Research Methodology

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: Choosing Methods	Which research methods would you recommend for collecting information from and investigating social impacts on the different groups in the community, and why? (150 words)	Identifies appropriate methods (e.g., survey, interview, focus group, mapping). Methods fit project context and community. Shows clear reasoning for selection.
Question 2: Ensuring Quality and Fairness	How would you ensure that the data collected is reliable, valid, and inclusive of different voices in the community? (150 words)	Awareness of quality checks in research. Consideration of representation and inclusivity. Recognition of fairness in the process.

Candidate Competency 3: Stakeholder Identification and Engagement

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: Identifying Stakeholders	Which main groups should be included for this project, and why are they important? (200 words)	Considers directly affected people. Considers institutions and authorities. Considers vulnerable or marginalised groups. Provides a reason for inclusion.
Question 2: Planning Consultations	How would you plan and run consultations so that different voices in the community are heard? (200 words)	Ensures inclusivity (women, youth, vulnerable groups). Shows cultural respect (protocols, traditional leaders). Mentions communication methods (local language, clear information). Notes transparency (records/feedback).

Candidate Competency 4: Impact Identification and Assessment

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: Identifying Impacts	Explain the difference between worker influx as a social change and the actual social impact it may cause. Give one example of a resulting social impact. (150 words)	Distinguishes project activity/change from resulting impact. Provides a clear example. Shows understanding of cause-effect link.
Question 2: Impact Assessment	What social impacts (positive and negative) do you think this project might create, and how would you decide which are the most significant? (200 words)	Identifies positive impacts. Identifies negative impacts. Uses clear criteria for significance (e.g., magnitude, duration, extent, vulnerability). Recognises role of community views in judging importance.

Candidate Competency 5: Mitigation Planning

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: Applying the Mitigation Hierarchy	How would you apply the mitigation hierarchy (avoid, minimise, restore, compensate) to manage the loss of grazing land and strain on local services? (200 words)	Refers to mitigation hierarchy steps. Suggests realistic measures (land/grazing, services). Links back to project scenario.
Question 2: Enhancement Strategies	What practical steps could be taken to maximise positive benefits (jobs, local businesses) for the community? (200 words)	Identifies job-related benefits. Mentions skills/training or local procurement. Suggests measures that fit the scenario.

Candidate Competency 6: Ethical and Cultural Sensitivity

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: Ethical Practice	What ethical issues must you keep in mind when consulting households about the project to ensure the process is fair and respectful? (150 words)	Awareness of key ethical considerations (informed consent, confidentiality, do-no-harm, voluntary participation). Recognition of trust-building elements. Notes fairness/inclusivity.
Question 2: Cultural Competence	Some areas used for rituals and grazing carry cultural importance. How would you take these cultural aspects into account during the SIA process? (150 words)	Acknowledges role of local traditions. Shows awareness of cultural spaces. Reflects balance between project needs and community values.

Candidate Competency 7: Legal and Policy Frameworks

Question	Task	Indicators
Question 1: Importance of Legal Alignment	Why is it important that the SIA process is aligned with legal and policy requirements? (150 words)	Shows understanding of the role of legal compliance in the SIA process. Connects alignment to accountability and credibility. Awareness of risks if requirements are ignored.
Question 2: Key Frameworks	Identify the key legal and policy frameworks that could inform this SIA, both nationally and internationally (clearly distinguish the two). (200 words)	Mentions relevant national laws/policies. Awareness of international standards/frameworks. Recognition of applicability to the scenario.

Section 4: Continuing Professional Development (CPD)

The Social Impact Assessment Practitioners (SIAP) professional board is committed to maintaining the highest standards of professional practice in social impact assessment across South Africa. The CPD Policy ensures that practitioners remain current with evolving methodologies, legislative frameworks, stakeholder expectations, and societal contexts.

Definition of CPD

CPD is defined as: the systematic maintenance, improvement, and broadening of knowledge and skills, and the ongoing development of personal qualities necessary for the execution of professional and technical duties, and contribution to capacity building in the field, throughout a Social Impact Assessment Practitioner's working life.

Purpose of CPD

Continuing Professional Development (CPD) is essential to:

- Maintain competence — Ensure practitioners remain current with evolving methodologies, legislation, and best practices in social impact assessment.
- Enhance quality — Improve the standard of SIA practice across South Africa through ongoing learning and skill development.
- Build public trust — Demonstrate the profession's commitment to accountability, ethical practice, and continuous improvement.
- Support career growth — Provide structured opportunities for practitioners to deepen expertise and expand their professional capabilities.
- Foster professional community — Encourage knowledge-sharing, collaboration, and peer learning among SIA practitioners.

Scope & Applicability

This CPD Policy applies to all registered members of the SIAP Board:

- Candidate SIA Practitioners — Members who are working towards full professional registration.
- Professional SIA Practitioners — Fully registered practitioners.

CPD obligations begin from the date of registration in either category. Members are required to complete CPD activities within each designated five-year CPD cycle. All CPD points earned as a Candidate SIAP remain valid and count toward the 25-point requirement upon transition to Professional SIAP status.

CPD Requirements Overview

All registered Social Impact Assessment practitioners must complete a minimum of 25 CPD points over a five-year registration cycle. Points must be earned across all three categories, each with specific minimum requirements. Points cannot be transferred between registration cycles.

Requirement	Details	Minimum/Maximum
Total Points Required	25 points over 5 years	Mandatory
Category 1: SIA Professional Development	Structured learning	Min. 5 points over 5 years
Category 2: Professional SIA Practice	Practical project work	Optional, max. 10 points / 5 years
Category 3: Growing the SIA Profession & Self-Directed Development	Mentoring, contributions, membership	Min. 5 points over 5 years

CPD Categories in Detail

Category 1: SIA Professional Development

Purpose: Demonstrate knowledge progression, enhanced understanding, and updated technical skills through attendance at structured developmental activities.

Activity	Evidence Required	Points
Attend SIA-related conferences, lectures, seminars, workshops, or colloquiums. Attend relevant meetings or courses of professional organisations. Attend refresher or training courses. Attend training seminars within your own organisation.	Conference/workshop programmes. Attendance registers. Assignments submitted. Certificates awarded. Tax invoices. Personal declaration of lessons learned.	10 hours = 1 point. Compulsory — minimum 5 points over 5-year cycle. No annual minimum.

Category 2: Professional SIA Practice

Purpose: Demonstrate practical application of SIA knowledge through actual project work, including supervision of candidate practitioners and managerial activities.

Activity	Evidence Required	Points
Completed SIA Report (Basic Assessment, Scoping, EIA). Completed standalone SIA process. Completed Social Management Plan. Completed RAP, Livelihood Restoration Plan, or Social and Labour Plans.	All SIA and related Social Performance reports finalised and submitted.	200 hours = 1 point. 400 hours = 2 points. Optional — max. 2 points/year, 10 points/5 years.

Category 3: Growing the SIA Profession

Purpose: Demonstrate contributions to the SIA profession through skills transfer, capacity building, awareness raising, and professional service. This category has three sub-categories:

Category 3(a): Membership of Professional Bodies

Qualifying Membership	Evidence Required	Points
IAIA or IAIAAs; South African affiliate organisations; other recognised professional bodies related to SIA practice.	Membership certificate, proof of payment, membership card.	Optional — Max. 1 point/year.

Category 3(b): Individual Professional Contributions (Optional — max. 3 points/year, 15 points/5 years)

Activity	Evidence Required	Points
Presentations at conferences, workshops, and seminars	Copy of brochures/programmes with presentation title and name, evidence of delivery	1 point each
Publication of conference papers, journal articles, or technical reports	The actual publication; acceptance letter from editor or conference organiser	1 point per publication per author
Pro bono SIA work for NGOs, CBOs, or advocacy organisations	Minutes of meetings, letters of appointment, copies of reports or written advice, attendance registers	1 point for 10 hours
Involvement in professional committees, working groups, or panels	Records of organisation; written confirmation from recipient organisation	1 point for 10 hours
Attain relevant postgraduate qualification (Honours, Masters, PhD)	Certified copy of qualification and academic records/transcripts	3 points
Part-time training, tutoring, or guest lecturing at universities or training institutions	Academic institution records, course notes, letter of invitation, receipts for payments	1 point for 10 hours
External examination of postgraduate dissertations or academic programmes	Letter of appointment, examiner's report	Honours = 1 point; Masters/PhD = 2 points. Max. 2 points/year
Co-ordinate and/or host short courses	Course programme, register of participants, and records of the organisation	1 point for 10 hours

Category 3(c): Training and Mentoring of Candidate SIAPs (Compulsory)

Purpose: Support the development of the next generation and candidate SIA practitioners through formal mentorship.

Activity	Evidence Required	Points
Formal mentorship of candidate SIA practitioners. Career guidance for	Written statement from recipient of mentoring.	20 hours = 1 point. Compulsory — min. 1

aspiring SIA practitioners. Supervision of workplace learning and development. Structured coaching of junior practitioners.	Mentorship agreement or plan. Records of mentorship sessions (dates, topics covered). Progress reports.	point/year; min. 5 points over 5 years.
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CPD Summary Table

Category	Description	Credit Calculation	Requirements
Cat. 1	SIA Professional Development	10 hrs = 1 pt	Compulsory: Min. 5 pts over 5 years
Cat. 2	Professional SIA Practice	200 hrs = 1 pt; 400 hrs = 2 pts	Optional: Max. 2 pts/year, 10 pts/5 years
Cat. 3(a)	Professional Membership	1 pt per membership	Optional: Max. 1 pt/year
Cat. 3(b)	Individual Contributions	Varies by activity	Optional: Max. 3 pts/year, 15 pts/5 years
Cat. 3(c)	Mentorship	20 hrs = 1 pt	Compulsory: Min. 1 pt/year, 5 pts/5 years
TOTAL			Minimum 25 points over 5 years

Documentation and Record Management

Practitioners are responsible for maintaining a comprehensive CPD portfolio throughout their five-year registration period. Your portfolio should include:

- Certificates and confirmations — official documents showing completion or attendance of courses, workshops, conferences, or training sessions.
- Event documentation — programmes, agendas, or brochures from professional events attended, clearly showing dates and participation.
- Publications and presentations — copies of any papers, articles, or materials authored or presented, including conference proceedings.
- Project records — documentation of completed SIA work, such as final reports, client letters, or submission confirmations.
- Mentorship logs — detailed records of mentoring activities, including dates, duration, and written confirmations from mentees.
- Professional service records — minutes, appointment letters, or correspondence proving committee involvement or pro bono contributions.
- Financial records — receipts or invoices for paid training or conference attendance.
- Personal reflections — brief notes on what was learned and how it applies to SIA practice.

CPD Submission & Compliance

Practitioners must submit their complete CPD portfolio at least three months before their five-year registration expires. Submissions must be made through the online member portal. Late submissions may be made up to one month from the date of expiry with a valid written reason; submissions after this date without prior approval may result in non-compliance status.

Exemptions and Special Circumstances

Members may apply for a temporary exemption from CPD requirements in the following circumstances:

- Extended illness or medical incapacity (with supporting documentation).
- Parental leave (maternity or paternity) exceeding six months.
- Extended absence from practice due to exceptional personal circumstances.
- Other circumstances at the discretion of the SIAP Board.

Policy Review

This CPD Policy is reviewed every five years at the end of each registration cycle, or more frequently if significant issues arise, in response to changes in legislation or professional standards, or following substantial member feedback. Policy amendments will be communicated to all members at least six months before implementation. Changes apply from the next cycle onward; current registered members will not be disadvantaged during their existing registration cycle.

Section 5: Roles and Qualifications

Role Description: Social Impact Assessment Practitioner (SIAP)

A SIAP analyses and manages the social consequences of a project, policy, or programme on individuals and communities. Their role involves identifying and understanding potential social impacts, engaging with stakeholders, recommending mitigation measures, and monitoring social outcomes to ensure sustainable and equitable development. They are key to ensuring projects align with social responsibility and community well-being.

Key Responsibilities

- Conduct socio-economic baseline studies using appropriate social research methods.
- Gather data on demographics, livelihoods, community structures, social services, land use, health, education, and cultural practices.
- Identify stakeholders (including communities, government entities, vulnerable or marginalised groups, civil society, and traditional leadership) and facilitate inclusive, ethical engagement processes.
- Identify, predict, and assess positive, negative, and cumulative social impacts.
- Analyse social change processes, power dynamics, risks, and opportunities.
- Apply social science theories and frameworks to guide impact prediction.
- Rate impact significance and justify findings using accepted methodologies.
- Develop practical mitigation, enhancement, and social management measures.
- Align social measures with the mitigation hierarchy (avoid, minimise, restore, offset, enhance).
- Prepare clear, accurate SIA reports and supporting documentation.
- Coordinate with interdisciplinary teams within EIA/ESIA processes.
- Monitor social commitments and track actual social outcomes.
- Uphold professional ethics, community rights, and legislative requirements.

Qualifications for Registration as a SIAP

Educational Qualifications

Social Impact Assessments should be undertaken by suitably qualified and experienced professionals with a strong grounding in social science methodologies. Applicants must demonstrate a solid understanding of applied social science methods, research design, community engagement, and impact analysis.

Minimum educational requirements include a relevant bachelor's, honours, or master's degree in a social science or related discipline. Qualifying degrees include (but are not limited to):

Category	Qualification / Discipline	Relevance to SIA
Social Sciences	Sociology	Core social analysis, community dynamics

	Social Work	Community welfare, vulnerable groups
	Anthropology	Cultural analysis, ethnography, community research
	Industrial Sociology	Workplace and labour impacts
	Psychology	Behavioural impacts, mental health, community wellbeing
	Industrial Psychology	Organisational and workforce impacts
	Philosophy	Ethics, value systems, normative analysis
	Historical Studies	Heritage, contextual and longitudinal analysis
Development & Policy	Development Studies	Livelihood analysis, poverty, rural/urban development
	Public Governance / Public Administration	Policy frameworks, government engagement
	Politics / Political Science	Power dynamics, governance, policy analysis
	Public Health	Health impact assessment, epidemiology
	Gender Studies	Gender-disaggregated analysis, inclusion frameworks
	African Studies	Contextual knowledge of African communities and cultures
Spatial & Environmental	Geography (Human / Social)	Spatial analysis, land use, displacement
	Urban and Regional Planning	Settlement planning, infrastructure impacts
	Environmental Management / Studies	EIA integration, environmental-social interface
	Land Use Planning	Tenure, resettlement, agricultural impacts
Economics & Law	Economics	Socio-economic profiling, cost-benefit, livelihoods
	Law	Legal compliance, rights-based approaches, land law
	Labour Relations	Employment impacts, worker rights
Communication & Research	Communication Science	Stakeholder communication, public participation

	Research Psychology	Social research methodology, survey design
	Journalism / Media Studies	Community information, public awareness
	Social Research / Applied Social Science	Direct methodological grounding for SIA
Education & Community	Education	Capacity building, literacy-sensitive engagement
	Community Development	Grassroots engagement, participatory approaches

Candidate SIA Practitioner Requirements

A Candidate SIAP must meet at least one of the following criteria:

- Currently completing a relevant undergraduate or postgraduate programme in the disciplines listed above.
- Recently graduated but have not yet acquired the required experience for full registration.
- Possessing an environmental or related degree but still working toward additional social-science-specific competencies.

Candidate registration allows emerging professionals to practise under supervision while gaining the experience required for Full SIAP status.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Applicants without a formal degree may be considered under a Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) pathway.

To qualify through RPL, applicants must provide evidence of:

- Substantial and relevant professional experience in social impact assessment or related fields.
- Demonstrated ability to apply social research methods, stakeholder engagement, and impact evaluation in practice.
- Portfolio of evidence (reports, community engagement records, impact assessments, etc.).

Professional Certification

Applicants may enhance their professional standing through recognised certifications such as the International Association for Impact Assessment (IAIA) Social Impact Assessment Professional Certification.

Other internationally or nationally recognised training courses in SIA, social research, or community engagement are also considered.

Professional Experience Requirements

To qualify for full practitioner registration, an applicant must demonstrate:

- At least three years of relevant professional experience in SIA or related social assessment fields; or
- A minimum number of completed SIAs (e.g., lead author or contributing specialist on at least 3–5 SIA reports).

Experience should cover application of social research methodologies; stakeholder and community engagement; impact identification, prediction, and mitigation; report writing and presentation; and interdisciplinary teamwork within EIA/ESIA processes.

Registration Pathway Summary

Candidate SIAP: Relevant degree (or in progress) + registration with SIAP Board + supervision by a registered SIAP.

Professional SIAP: Relevant degree + minimum 3 years' experience (or 3–5 completed SIAs) + competency assessment + CPD compliance.

RPL Pathway: Substantial professional experience + portfolio of evidence + SIAP Board assessment.

Annexure A: CPD Record Sheet Template

The following record sheet must be completed and submitted as part of the CPD portfolio:

Name:	Email and Telephone:
SIAP Registration Number:	Five-Year Reporting Period:
<i>I declare that all information on this form is true, accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge.</i>	
Signature:	Date:

Category 1: SIA Professional Development					
CPD Activity No.	Description of Activity	Date/Period	Evidence	Hours	Points

Category 2: SIA Professional Practice					
CPD Activity No.	Description of Activity	Date/Period	Evidence	Hours	Points

Category 3: Growing the SIA Profession & Self-Directed Development					
CPD Activity No.	Description of Activity	Date/Period	Evidence	Hours	Points